

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio



Microsoft Learn module

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/modules/power-virtual-agents-bots/>



Why do we need agents?



Growing number of communication channels

Need consistent messaging



Streamlined workforces

Higher workloads,
capacity constraints,
time-starved employees



Higher customer/ colleague demands

Greater urgency,
higher expectations, and
decreased satisfaction

Achieve more with automation through conversation



Optimize digital
workforce



Faster time
to value



More time for
innovation

Is a Copilot just a chatbot?

Conversational AI

Chatbot

Conversational experience using trained NLU models

Common to be text based

Data queried with APIs vs grounding

Prebuilt content and topics by makers

Embedded into sites, but siloed

Context holding

Copilot

Evolution of chatbots as conversational assistants powered by large language models and generative AI to assist in your line of work.

Natural, multimodal interface

Enables more than just text formats.

Grounding in multiple data sources

Works with your internal and external data sources

Generative content capabilities

Generative AI powering Copilot building and response generation

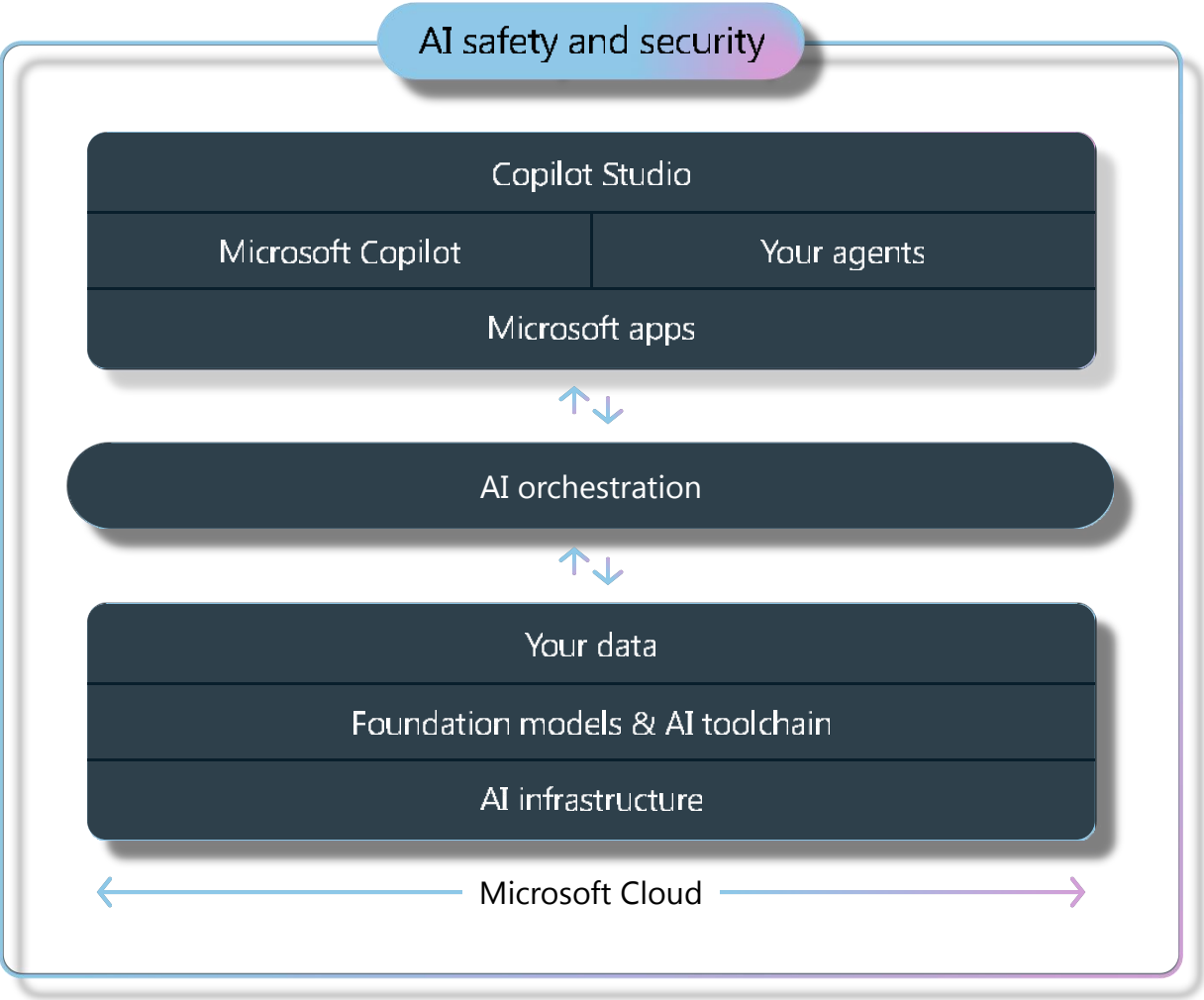
Contextual interactions

Connected to the app experience it lays

Responsiveness and adaptability

Flexible to configure to context of experience.

Copilot stack



Microsoft Copilot Studio

Build your own agent

Create and publish a custom agent for your organization using the intuitive building experience enhanced with large language models and generative AI

Customize Microsoft Copilot

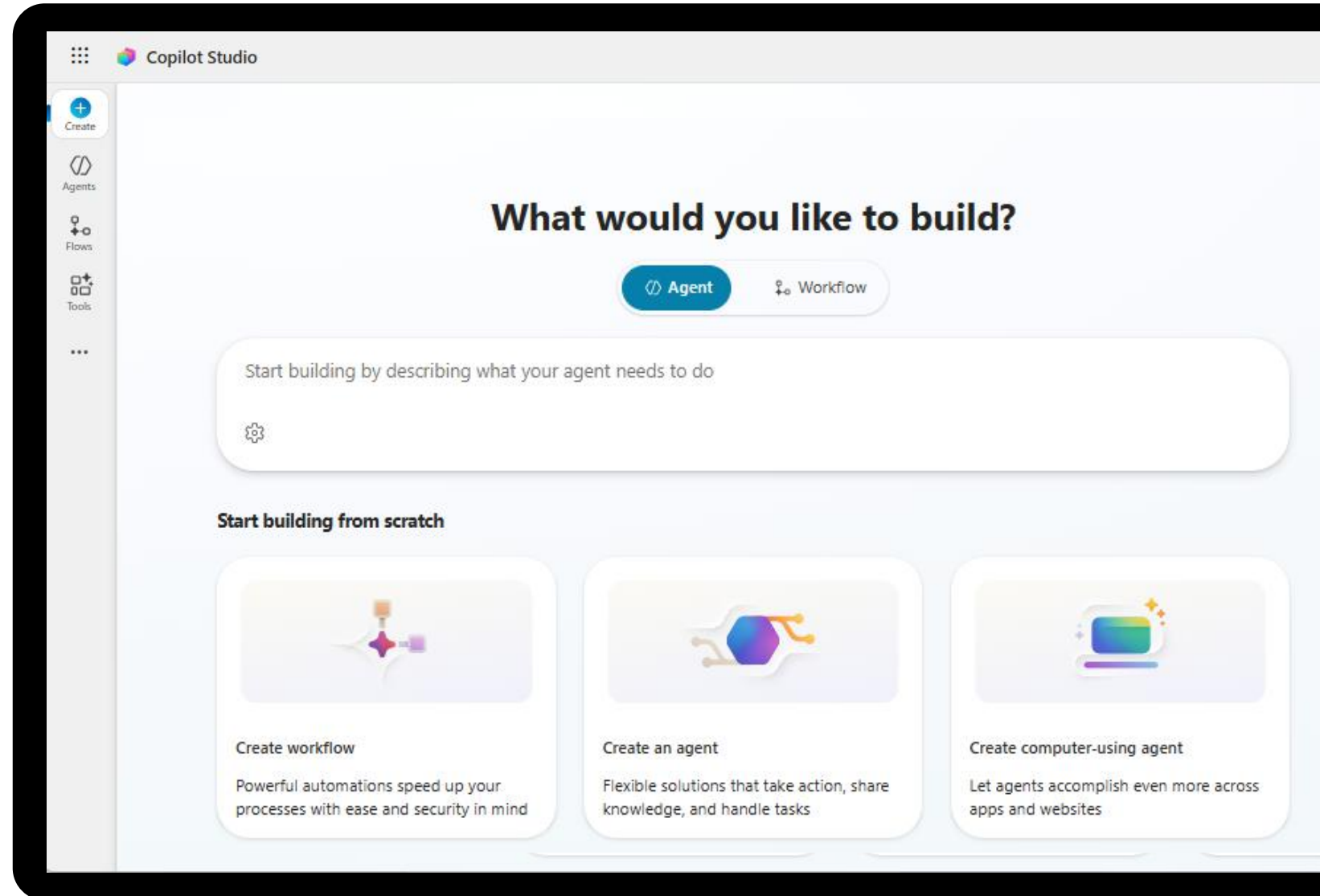
Extend and customize 1st party Microsoft Copilots with your own enterprise scenarios. Copilot Studio will be included with the Microsoft 365 Copilot SKU.

Connected platform

Integrates and exposes various Microsoft's conversational AI technology stacks - integrated with Azure AI Foundry, Azure AI Services, Azure Bot Framework, Power Platforms AI models and more

Manage copilot experiences

Governance and control features to monitor usage with full visibility of customizations, standalone agents as well as who is building and customizing them.



Build copilots that work for you

in your industry...

 Travel and Transport	Manage bookings	Change my trip dates
 Professional Services	Lead generation	Get a quote
 Government	Public programs	Get childcare assistance
 Retail	Manage orders	I want to make an exchange
 Healthcare	Claims	Submit health insurance claim
 Financial Services	Manage accounts	Report lost card
 Education	Admissions	How to get financial aid?
 Manufacturing	Supply	Check stock

...and department

Customer Service Reduce call volume for quick resolutions  Request a refund Describe your issue Support tickets Centralized FAQs	Finance Save time by automating budget and expense approvals  Update tax information Submit expenses for approval Payroll Budget requests	HR Improve employee satisfaction and retention  Sign up for healthcare plan Book time off Benefits Leave and absence
IT Optimize employee troubleshooting  Reset my password Refresh my laptop Support services Equipment requests	Operations Improve efficiency by digitizing paper processes  Find case file Check order delivery times Find documents Manage inventory	Sales and Marketing Increase up-sell and conversion opportunities  You're eligible for a free upgrade! Update your email preferences Upselling Email

Use cases

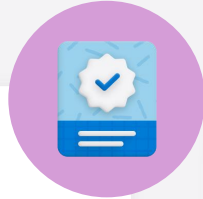
- Sales help and support issues
- Opening hours and store information.
- Employee health and vacation benefits.
- Public health tracking information.
- Common employee questions for businesses.

Get started working with environments

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

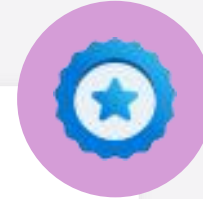


Create environments



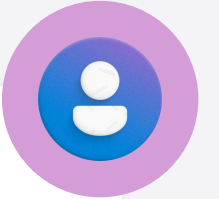
Default environment

- Default environment created when signing in.
- Agents created in the default environment.
- Specify otherwise to create agents in different environments.



Adding more environments

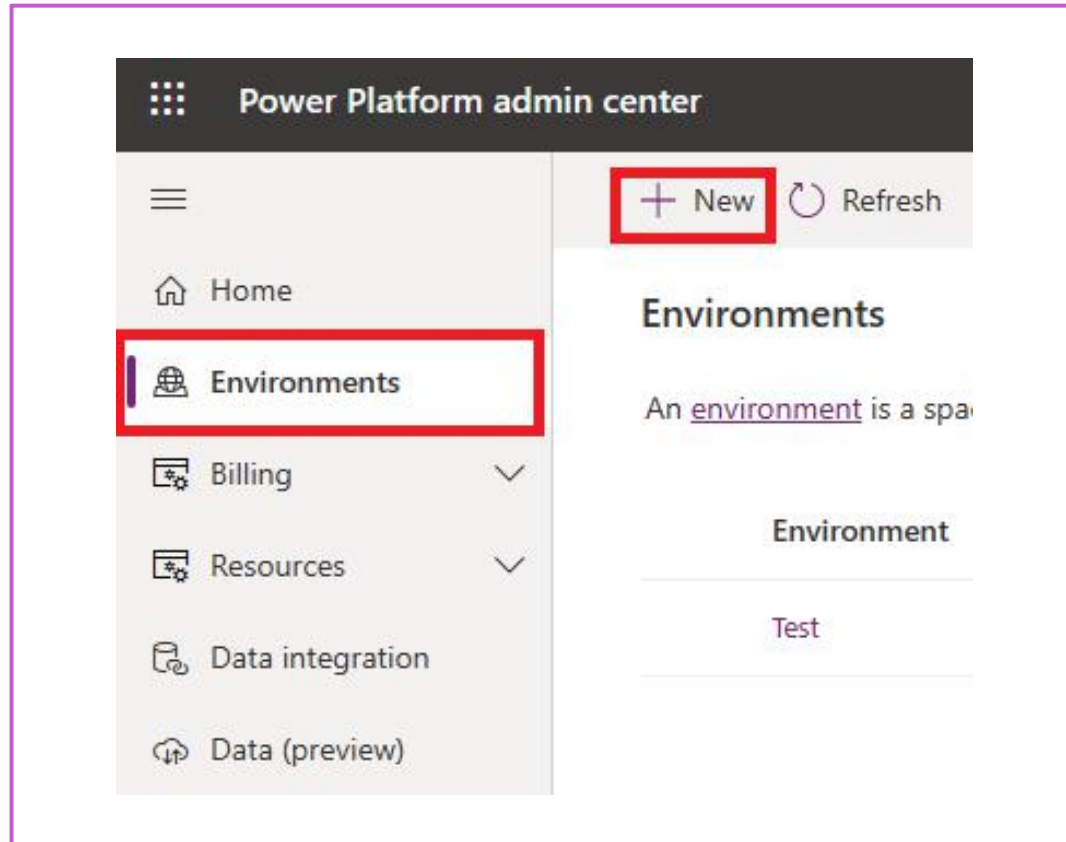
- Add more environments for different regions.
- Organizational needs or other circumstances.
- Use Microsoft Power Platform admin center.



Microsoft Power Platform admin center

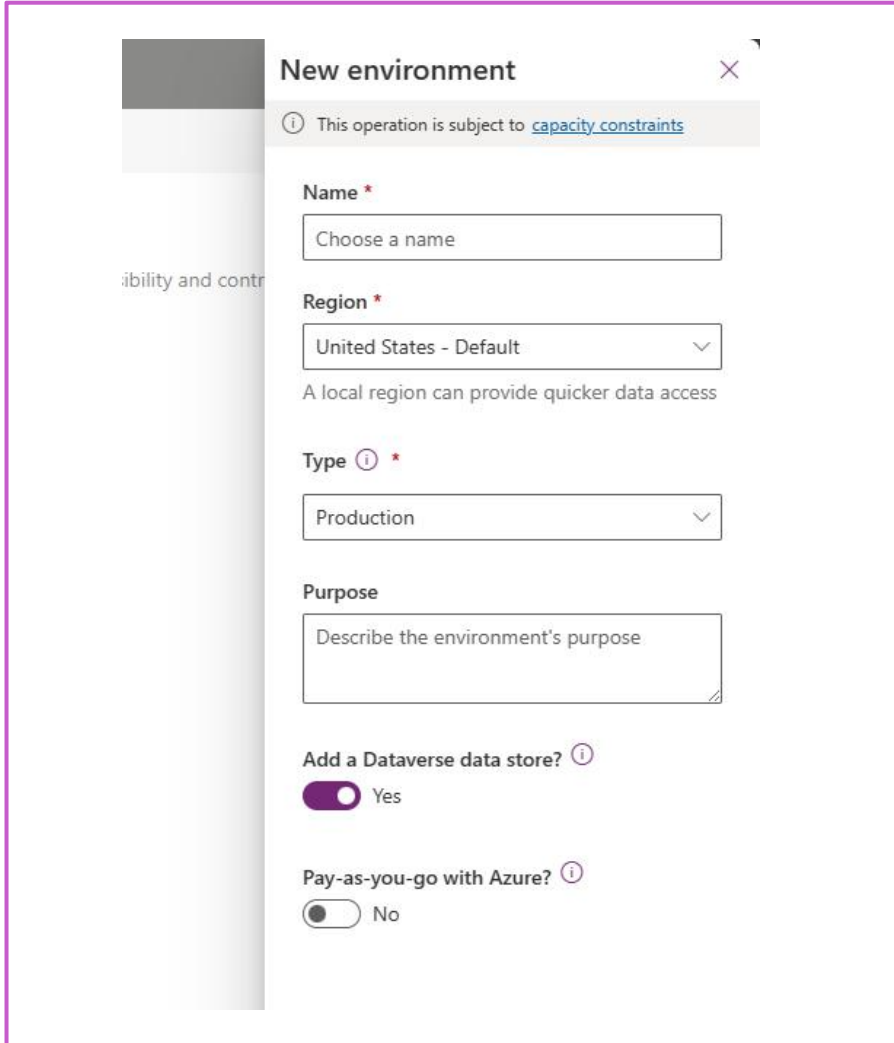
- For more information, see creating environments.
- Establish environments for each region.
- Use and store data for customers in that region.

Environments in Microsoft Copilot Studio



- Environments help manage and share business data, including agents, apps, and flows, effectively.
- Environments can have different roles, security requirements, and target audiences.
- Organizations may decide to align their environment strategy by departments or by location.
- Global companies need multiple environments for data privacy.

Understanding Default Environments in Copilot Studio



The screenshot shows a 'New environment' dialog box with the following fields and options:

- Name ***: A text input field with the placeholder 'Choose a name'.
- Region ***: A dropdown menu showing 'United States - Default'. Below it, a note states: 'A local region can provide quicker data access'.
- Type ⓘ ***: A dropdown menu showing 'Production'.
- Purpose**: A text area with the placeholder 'Describe the environment's purpose'.
- Add a Dataverse data store? ⓘ**: A toggle switch set to 'Yes'.
- Pay-as-you-go with Azure? ⓘ**: A toggle switch set to 'No'.

- A default environment is created upon signing in for the first time.
- All subsequent agents are created in the default environment unless specified otherwise.
- Additional environments can be added for various needs and regions.
- Manage your environments in the Power Platform admin center.

What is Copilot Studio

Creating an agent

Select the *environment* in which to create the agent

Describe the desired agent features and capabilities in a chat interface

or

Select a template for common agent implementations

The screenshot shows the Copilot Studio web interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'Home', 'Create', 'Agents', and 'Library' buttons. The main heading is 'Describe your agent to create it'. Below this, there's a chat interface with a prompt: 'Use everyday words to describe what your agent should do'. To the right of the chat, there are buttons for 'Helpdesk', 'Expense tracking', and 'HR and benefits'. Below the chat, there's a 'Recent' section with a table of agents. Below that, there's an 'Explore agents' section with various templates.

Name	Type	Last modified	Last published	Owner
Copilot for Microsoft 365	Microsoft		Never	
Copilot	Agent	# Microsoft Copilot Studio...	Never	Bre'Ana Deen

Explore agents

Templates are currently a preview feature. See [supplemental terms](#)

- Safe Travels**: Provides answers to common travel questions and related health and safety guidelines.
- Website Q&A**: Instantly answer user questions using the content of your web site or other knowledge.
- Team Navigator**: Assists employees in finding colleagues and their hierarchy within the organization using Microsoft Teams.
- IT Helpdesk**: Empowers employees to resolve issues and effortlessly create/view support tickets.
- Store Operations**: Improve the efficiency of retail frontline workers by enabling easy access to store procedures and policies.
- Financial Insights**: Helps financial services professionals get quick and accurate info from their org's financial documents and other available resources.

What is Copilot Studio?

Key concepts

Predefined paths that orchestrate the flow of conversational dialogs

Topics



Data sources searched by generative AI to create relevant responses

Knowledge



Automated tasks that can be initiated by an agent

Actions



Deployment options for making your published agent available to users

Channels



Metrics and data to assess agent performance and user satisfaction

Analytics



Create an agent in Copilot Studio



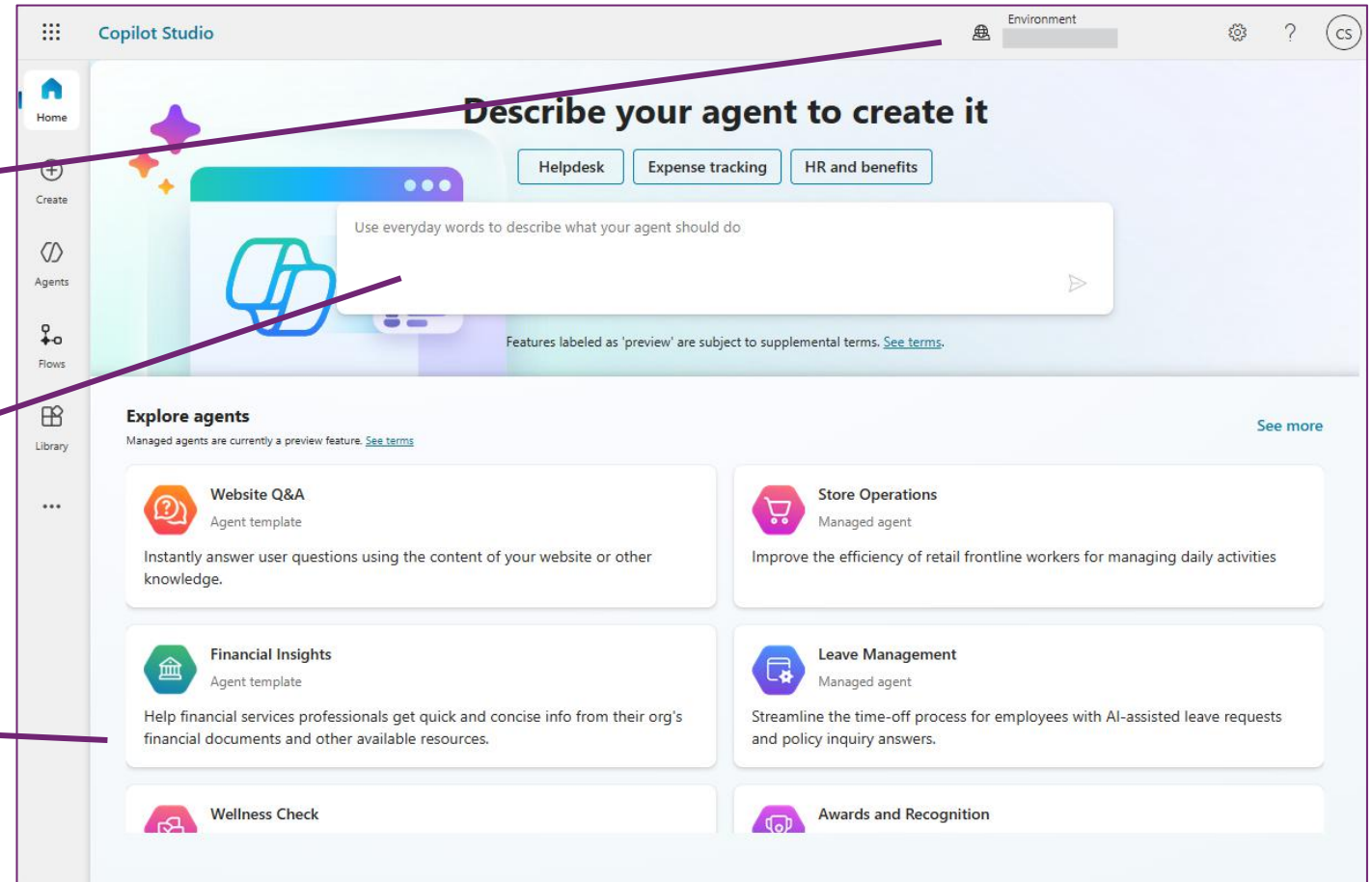
Explore Copilot Studio home

Select the *environment* in which to create the agent

Describe the desired agent features and capabilities in a chat interface

or

Select a template for common agent implementations



Create an agent dialog

Name and describe the agent

- Name your agent
- Select icon
- Describe the purpose of your agent
- Provide instructions for your agent
- Select language
- Add knowledge sources

Name

Give your custom agent a descriptive name so it's easy to identify. You can change this later if you need to.

Agent



 Change icon

Used to represent the agent. Icon should be in PNG format and less than 30 KB in size.

Description

Use your own words to describe what your agent should help with, including your audience and end goal.

Instructions

Direct the behavior of the agent, including its tasks and how it completes them.

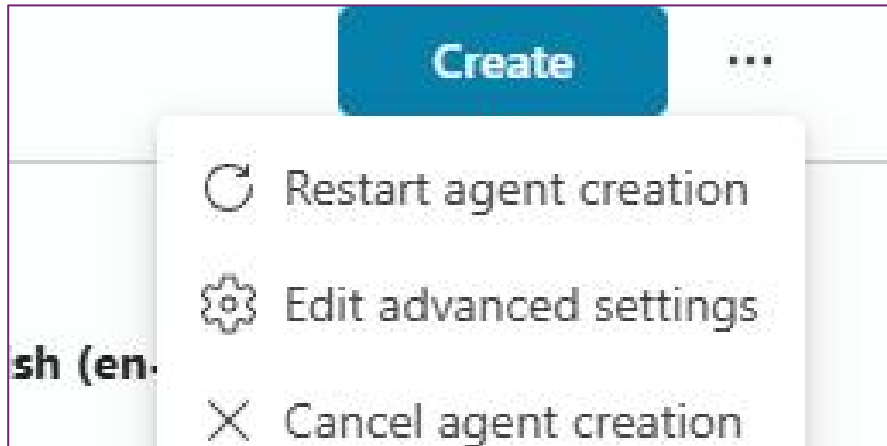
Starter prompts

 Add starter prompts

Suggest ways of starting conversations for Teams and Microsoft 365 channels. [Learn more.](#)

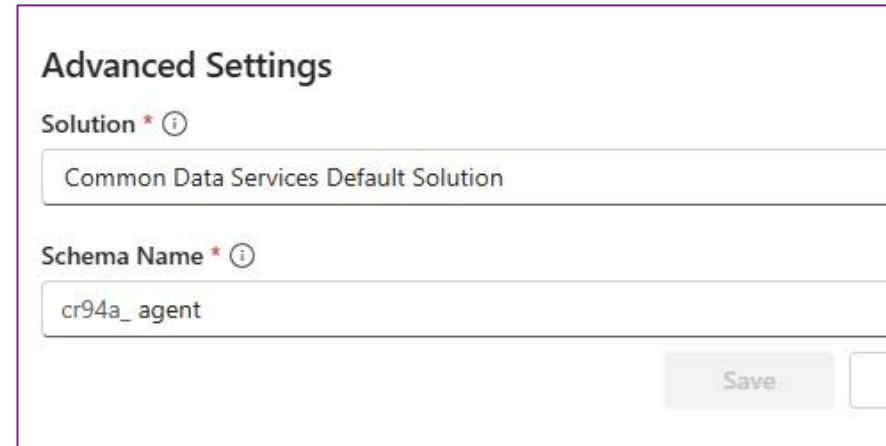


Advanced settings



Edit advanced settings

Select the three dots to show the Edit advanced settings menu option.

A screenshot of the 'Advanced Settings' form. The title 'Advanced Settings' is at the top. Below it is a 'Solution' field with a red asterisk and an information icon, containing the text 'Common Data Services Default Solution'. Below that is a 'Schema Name' field with a red asterisk and an information icon, containing the text 'cr94a_agent'. At the bottom right, there is a 'Save' button and a checkbox.

Configure advanced settings

- Select solution
- Enter schema name

Demo - Create an agent



Demo - Create an agent from a template



Configure Generative AI instructions



Generative AI features

In Copilot Studio, you can use the following generative AI features:



Create an instantly useful agent: With no manual authoring of topics required, an "empty" agent can generate answers based on knowledge sources you specify such as websites and files.



Harness AI general knowledge: When this option is enabled, the agent can answer general questions unrelated to your specific knowledge sources or topics.

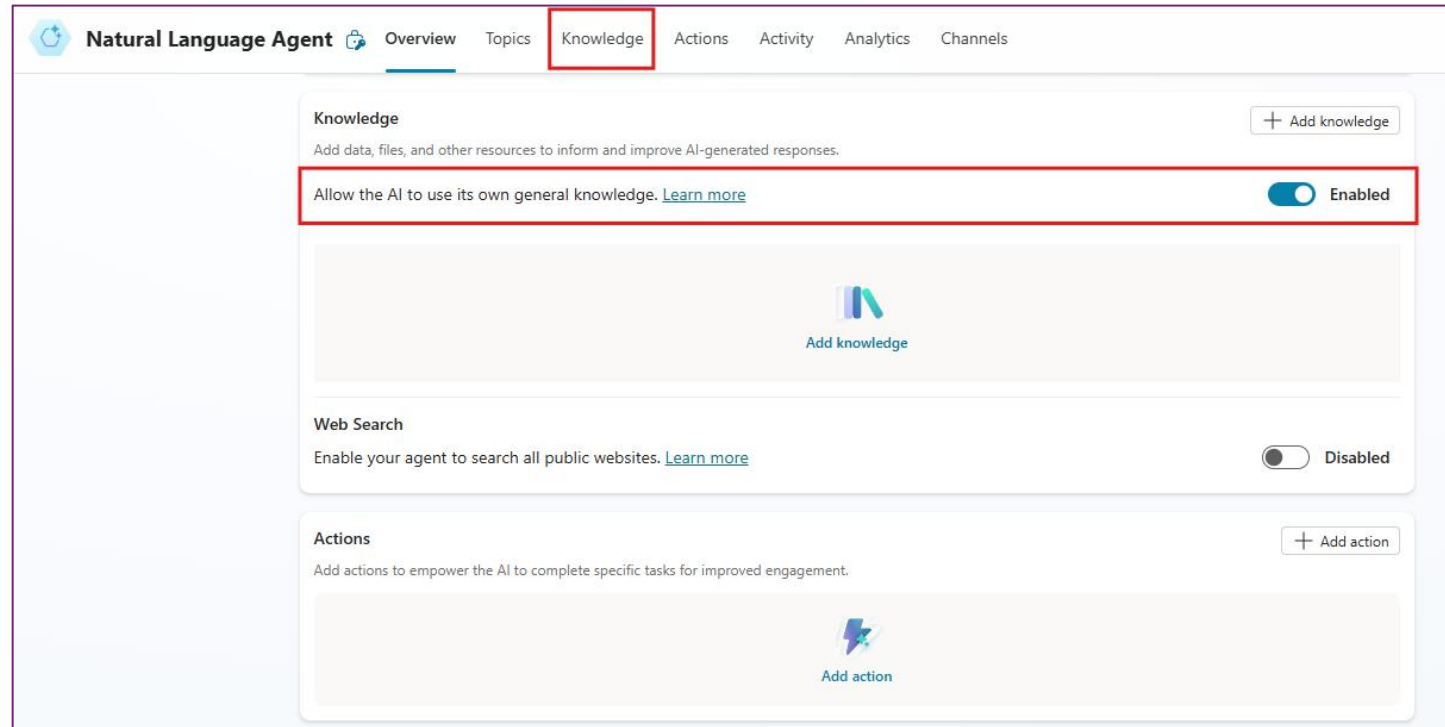


Author topics using natural language: Describe what you want your topic to do, and Copilot Studio creates it for you. Your agent includes conversational responses and multiple types of nodes.



Enable generative actions: Let the agent select the most appropriate topics and actions at runtime

AI general knowledge



- **Accessibility:** The agent can instantly access a vast repository of information and expertise across a wide range of subjects
- **Versatility:** It's capable of addressing diverse topics and tasks, making it a versatile resource for a variety of needs
- Allow AI to use its own general knowledge

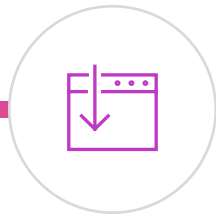
Generative answers

The supported knowledge sources are:



Public Website

Searches the query input on Bing, only returns results from provided websites



SharePoint

Connects to a SharePoint URL, uses GraphSearch to return results



Dataverse

Connects to the connected Dataverse environment and uses retrieval-augmented generative technique in Dataverse to return results



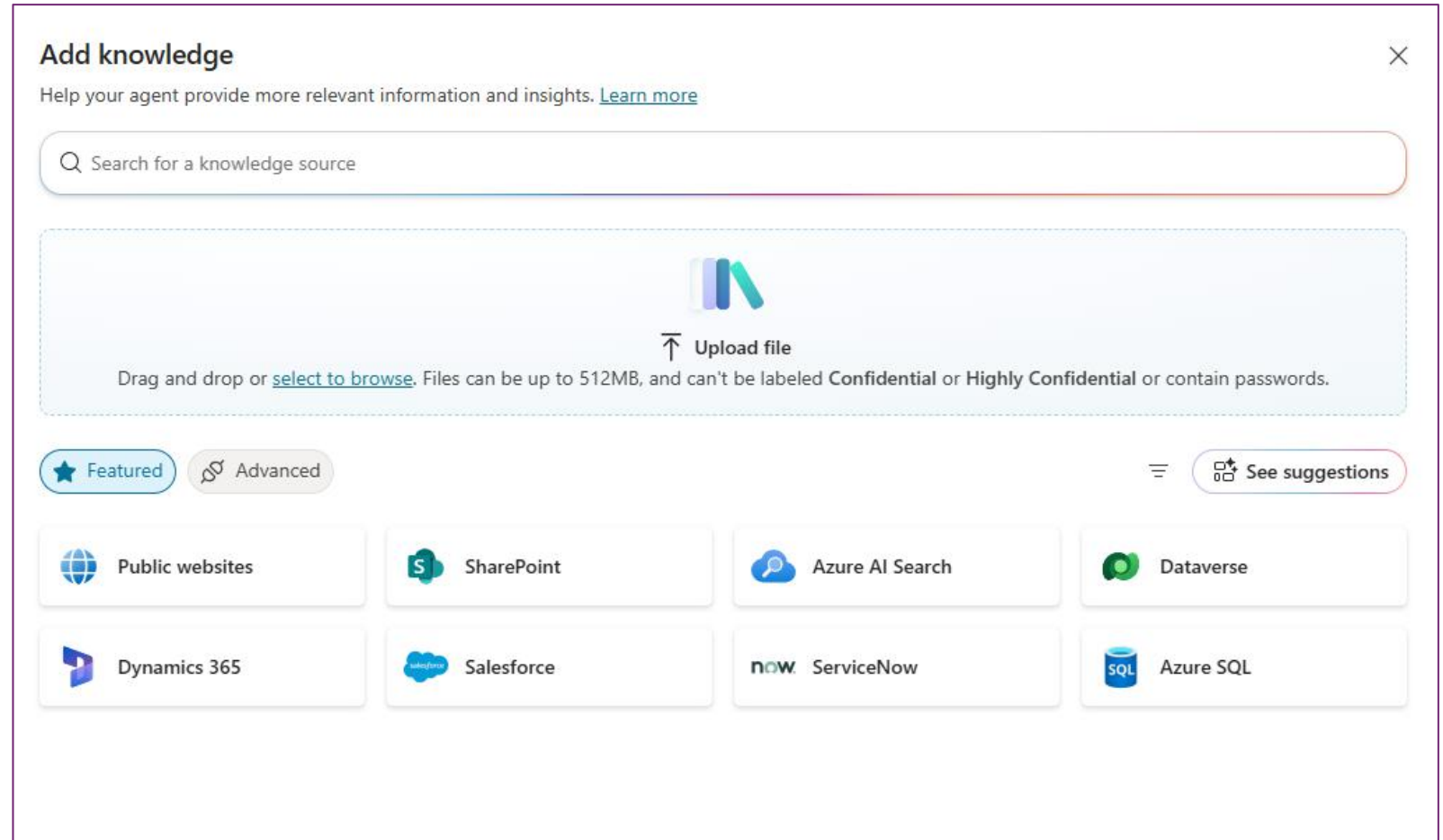
File Upload

Searches uploaded documents, returns results from the document contents

Knowledge sources

Copilot Studio

- Content your agent can reference directly
- Supports generative answers grounded in organizational content
- Includes files, websites, SharePoint, Dataverse, and internal data



Using websites as knowledge sources

URLs redirecting to another top-level site are not supported

For example, if www.fabrikam.com redirects to www.contoso.fabrikam.com, your agent will not generate responses

Websites that requires authentication or not indexed by Bing cannot be used.

For example, an internal site that require authentication like fab.visualstudio.com/project/wiki cannot be used.

URL can have up to two levels of depth

A trailing forward slash, however, is allowed

For example:

www.fabrikam.com/retail/stores/

Not:

www.fabrikam.com/retail/stores/us

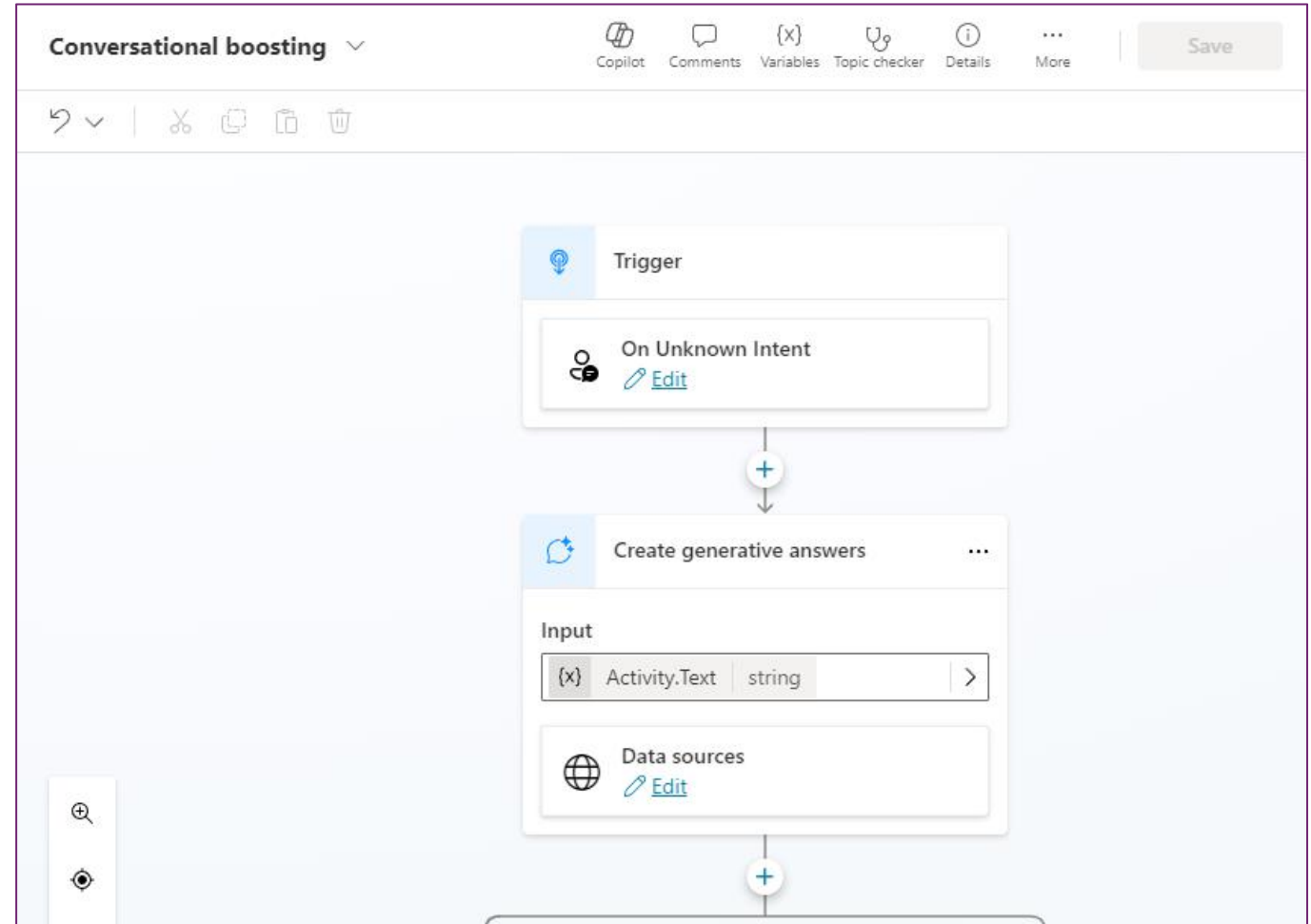
Using documents as knowledge sources

- Documents can be uploaded as a knowledge source for generative AI
- Documents are stored securely in Dataverse, and indexed for efficient search
- Document contents are visible to all agent users
- File size is limited to a max of 512 MB per upload
- Text-based files are recommended. Image, audio, video, and executable files are not supported

Conversational boosting topic

Create generative answers node

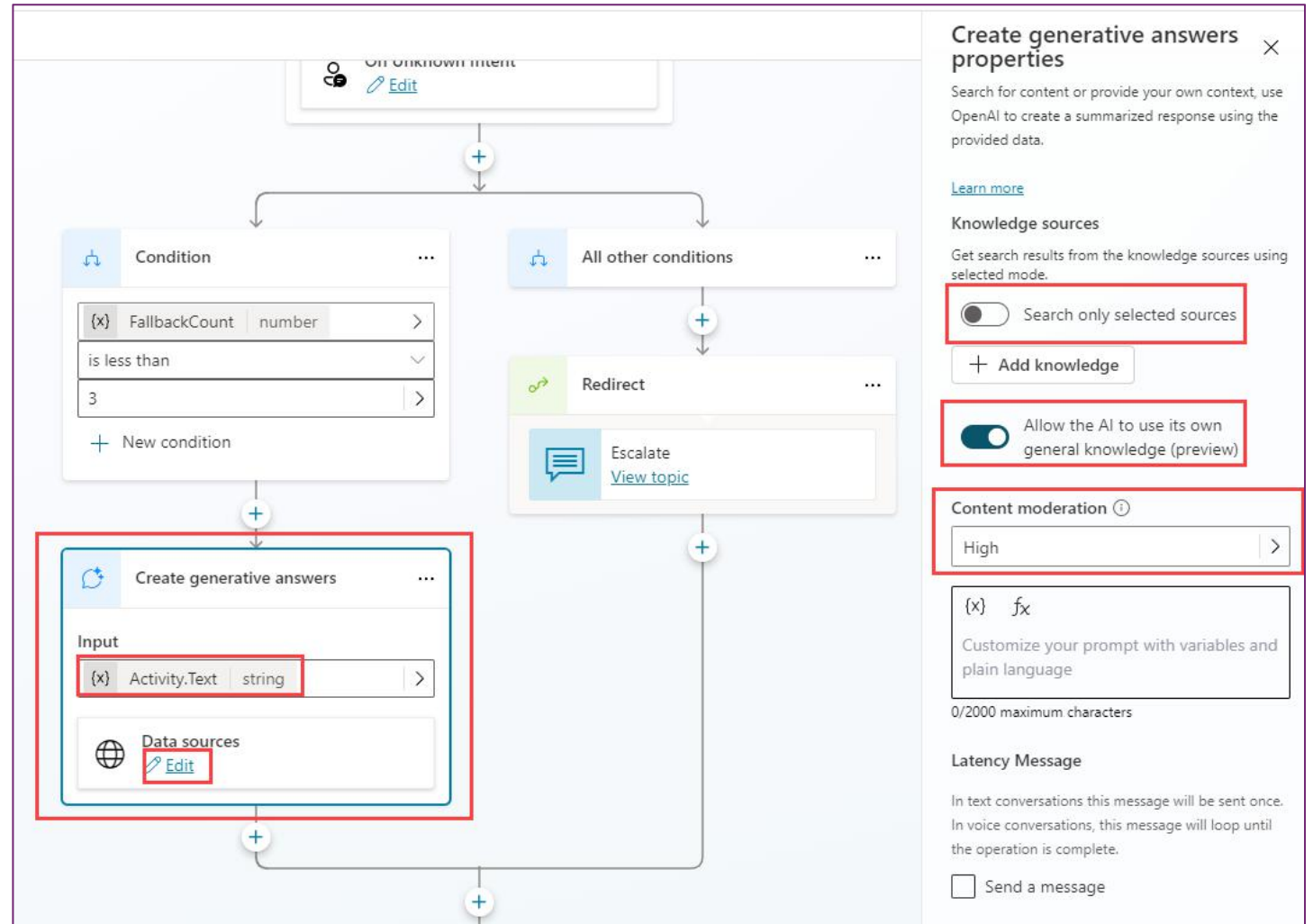
- Allows you to specify more sources that the node searches based on your inputs
- These sources override sources at the agent level



Fallback topic

Generative answers as a fallback

- Add Create generative answers node
- Specify knowledge
- Choose content moderation level



Demo - Add knowledge for generative answers



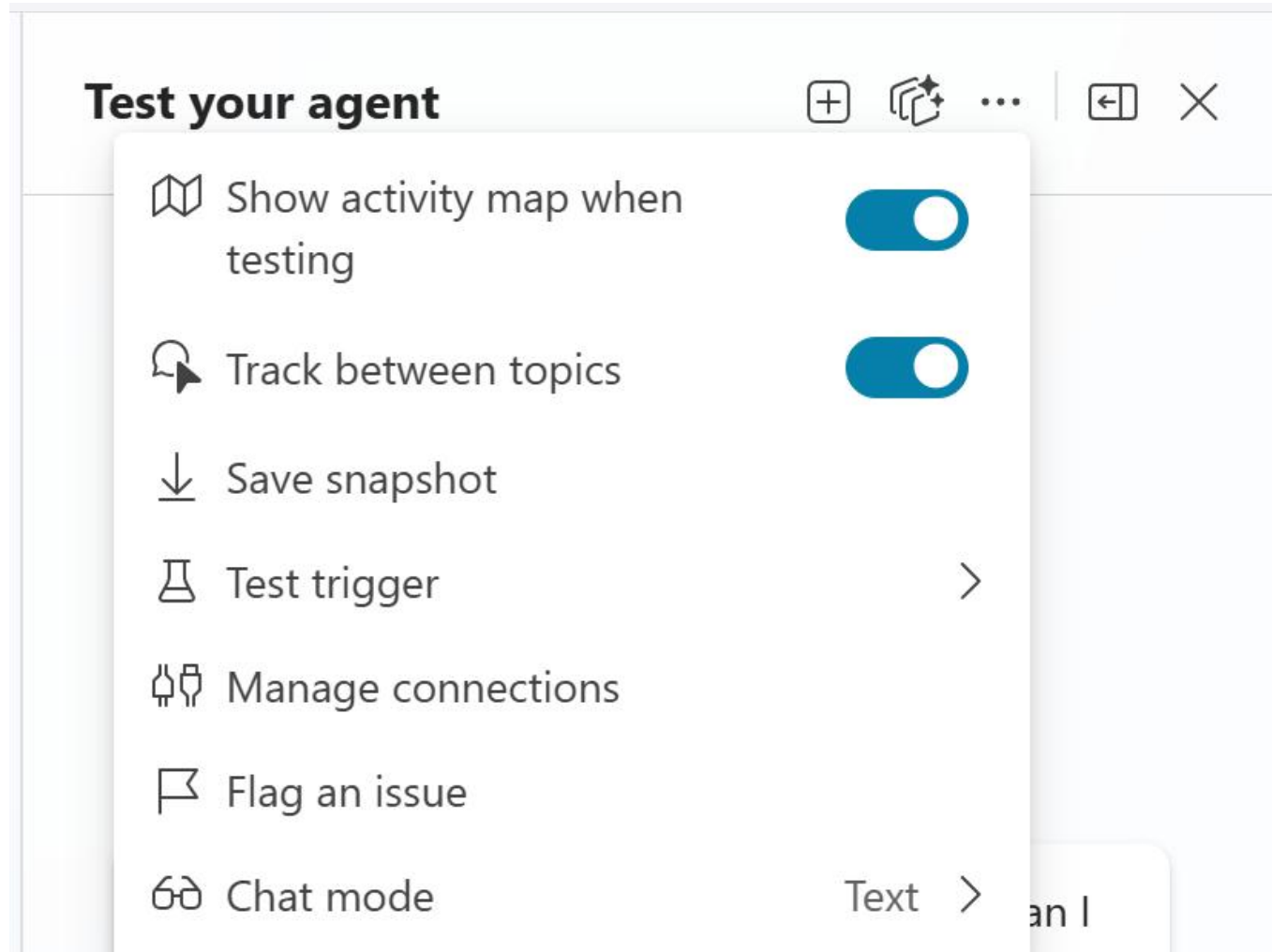
Deploy agents



Test agent

Test panel options

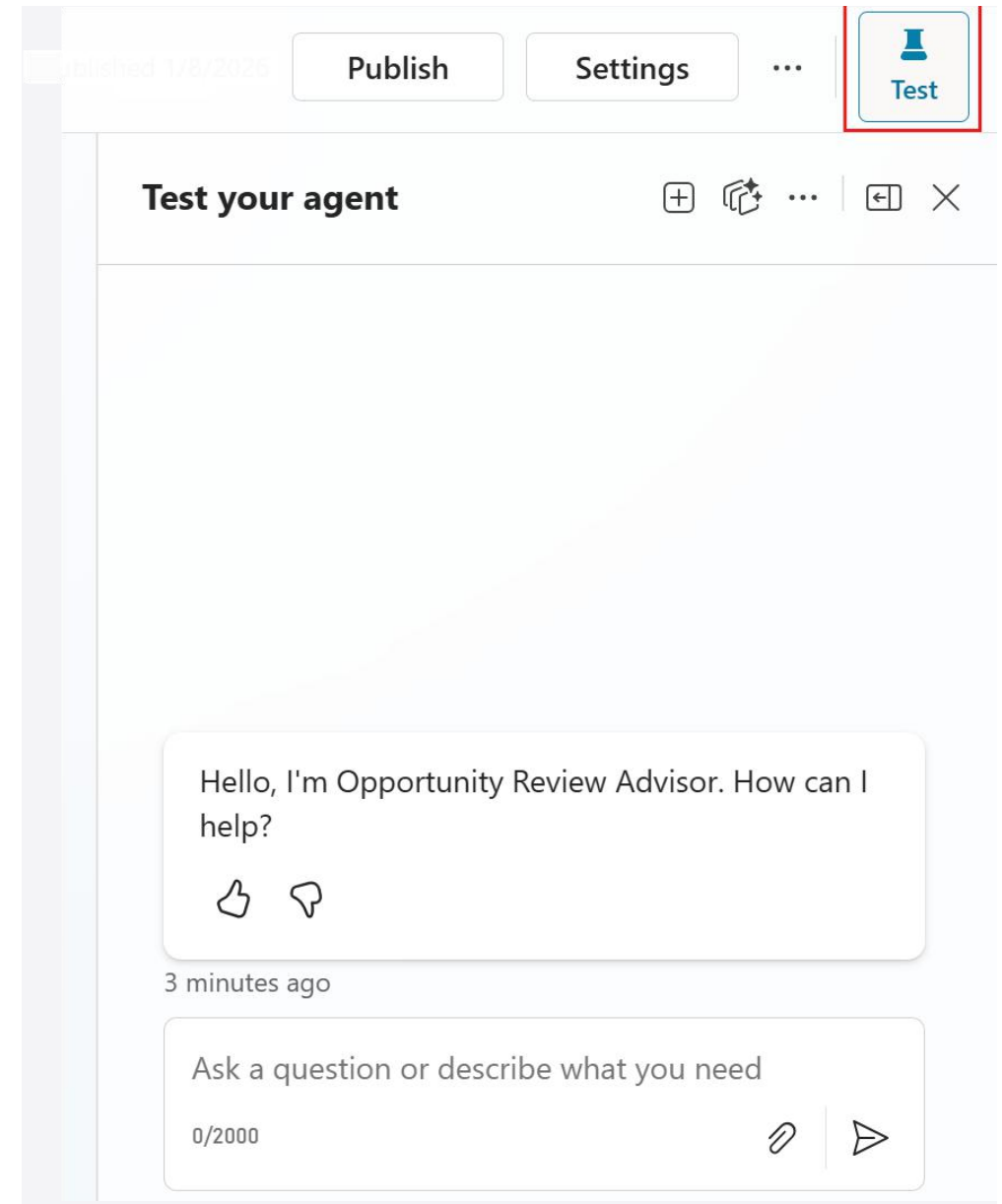
- Activity map
- Track between topics
- Start a new test session



Test panel

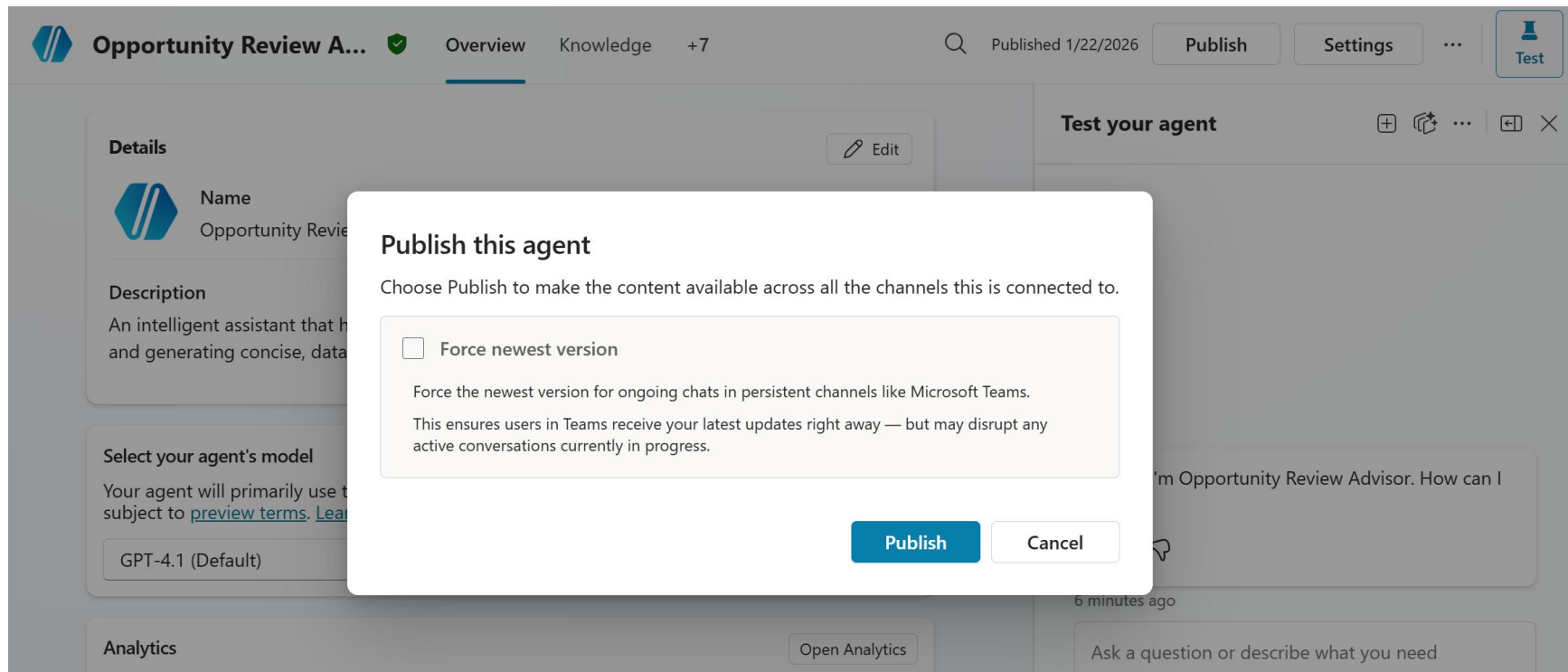
Show and hide by selecting Test button

- Ask questions or describe what you need
- View the results



Publish

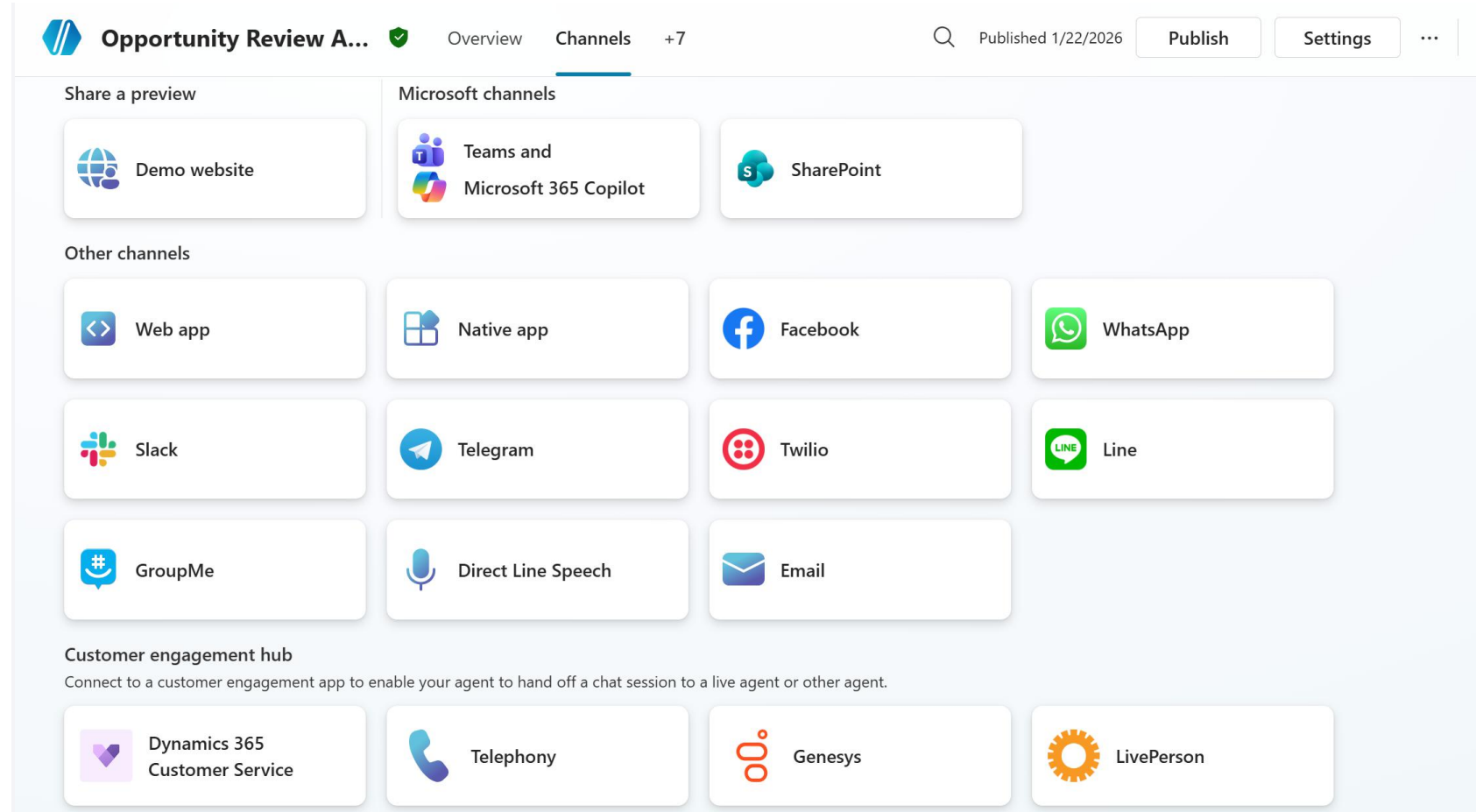
- Share with others
- Demo website
- Make the agent available on channels



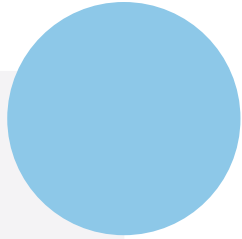
Teams channel

Deploy to Microsoft Teams

- Options to control the appearance of the agent
- Controls how a user can install the agent into a Microsoft Teams team

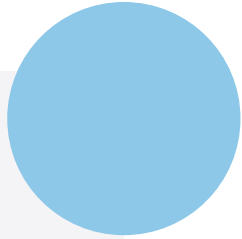


Practice Labs



Lab 1: Create an agent with Copilot Studio

Practice Labs



Lab 2: Import Dataverse solution

Knowledge Check



Knowledge Check



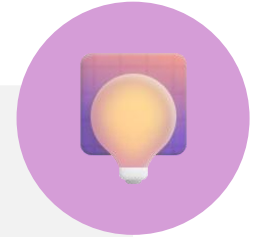
Learning Path 1

1. Use your PC or mobile device
2. Go to (***insert polling app link of your choice***)
3. Enter code: **123-45-678**
4. Please participate

Which one?

- A. None
- B. A little
- C. Lots

Knowledge Check



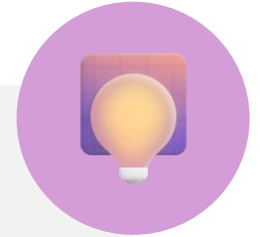
1 Out of the options provided, what data source can I connect Microsoft Copilot Studio to using the Generative answers feature?

- ✓ A public-facing website
- An internal website
- A hosted PDF in OneDrive Personal
- A file in GitHub

Solution

Answer=A

Knowledge Check



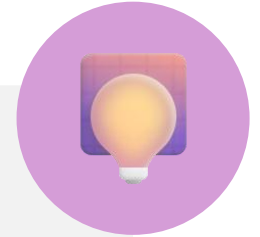
2 What is the primary purpose of using Copilot in Microsoft Copilot Studio?

- To automate website searches
- To enhance an agent's appearance
- ✓ To help agent creation by using natural language
- To deploy agents to multiple platforms

Solution

Answer=C

Knowledge Check



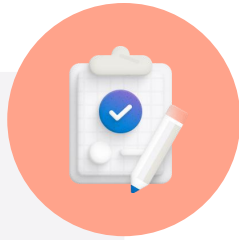
3 How do you test your agent in Microsoft Copilot Studio?

- ✓ Deploy the agent to Azure
- ✓ Select the Test button in the upper-right corner of the screen
- Turn on the "Track between topics" toggle
- Publish the agent to a test site

Solution

Answer=B

Summary



- Agents can be created manually, from a template, or by using natural language
- Natural language understanding identifies the user's intent and helps the agent determine the topic or action to use
- Adding knowledge enables the agent to retrieve and present information from various internal or external sources without the need for creating specific topics
- Agents must be published to share with others and deploy to users

Module Recap

In this module, we:

- Learned how to create and name a new agent by describing what the agent should do
- Learned how to configured Generative AI instructions and add grounding knowledge
- Learned how to test, publish, and share agents

